

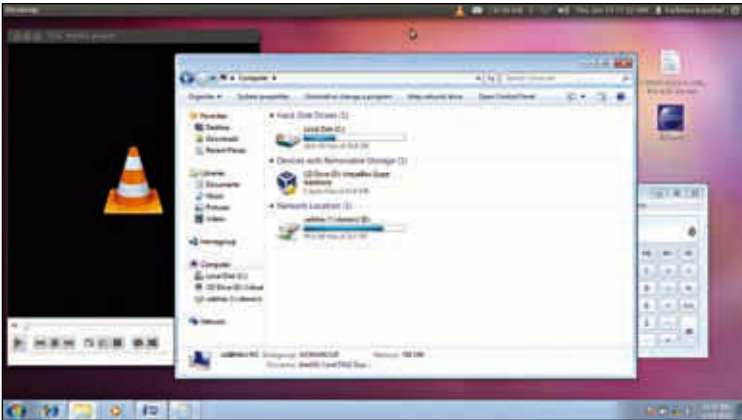


Figure 16: Explorer and Calculator of Windows 7 in Seamless mode in VirtualBox running on Ubuntu

Workstation’s “Unity” feature. You can activate it after starting the virtual machine. Just go to the virtual machine’s window and on the top menu bar, click on **View > Switch to Seamless Mode**. Once done, you’ll have the guest operating system’s windows on your host operating system as if they were normal windows.

You can see in the screenshot provided that two windows, one of the calculator application and the other of the Windows Explorer from a Windows 7 guest are put on a Ubuntu host’s desktop just like normal windows while a VLC media player window from Ubuntu is also present on the same desktop. The seamless mode of VirtualBox in some ways is better than VMware Workstation’s Unity feature. As you’d be able to see in the screenshot, VirtualBox in seamless mode has also enabled the almighty Windows taskbar on the host screen. This simply means that you’ll be able to minimize the applications and restore or maximize them later just as you did with the virtual machine being run in its own window. This provides a lot of ease of use, especially when you have to switch between different windows from both, your guest and the host and you’re someone who tends to minimize windows too much. With VMware Workstation’s Unity feature, you won’t be able to restore a window if you minimized it, unless and until you exit Unity and restore the window in the virtual machine’s tab.